SAINT MARTIN'S
LUTHERAN SCHOOL OF ANNAPOLIS

Brand Guidelines

A Christ-centered foundation for how Saint Martin's shows up — in print, online, and everywhere in between.

01 — BRAND OVERVIEW

Who we are

In a Christ-centered community, the teachers and staff of Saint Martin's Lutheran School foster spiritual and academic excellence in their students. Every design decision in this guide should carry that same balance forward: warmth and rigor, faith and achievement.

Audience

Christian parents evaluating private education across the DC metro and greater Annapolis area — families weighing faith formation alongside academic outcomes.

Primary application

This system is built first for saintmartinsannapolis.org, then extended to admissions materials, print, apparel, and signage.

Brand personality

Warm & Nurturing

Academically Rigorous

Every touchpoint should feel like a place a parent trusts their child's heart and mind to — not stiff or institutional, and not soft at the expense of substance. Warmth builds the welcome; rigor earns the confidence.

02 — VOICE & TONE

How we sound

Our voice speaks like a trusted teacher: clear, encouraging, and grounded in scripture without ever preaching at the reader.

We are

- Warm and personal
- Confident, not boastful
- Plainspoken about faith
- Encouraging

We are not

- Corporate or jargon-heavy
- Overly formal or academic-only
- Preachy or exclusionary
- Cutesy or childish

In practice

SAY THIS

"Your child grows here — in faith, in curiosity, and in character."

NOT THIS

"Our institution delivers a comprehensive, values-based educational framework."

03 — PRIMARY LOGO

Our mark



The primary lockup pairs the cross-and-column mark with the full wordmark. Use it as the default signature everywhere the school is introduced — the website header, letterhead, admissions materials.

Clear space



Maintain clear space equal to the height of the crest icon on all sides. Never let type, edges, or imagery intrude.

Minimum size



Never render the horizontal lockup narrower than 1.25in (print) or 180px (digital) wide.

03 — PRIMARY LOGO

Logo misuse

The mark loses trust the moment it's distorted. Never alter the lockup — always use approved files.



Don't stretch or distort



Don't place on low-contrast backgrounds



Don't recolor outside the palette



Don't rotate or add effects

04 — BULLDOG SPIRIT MARK

Bulldog, secondary mark

The bulldog carries school spirit — athletics, field day, spirit wear, and student-facing moments. It supports the brand but never replaces the primary academic logo on official communications, admissions, or the website header.



Where to use it

- Athletics uniforms & team communications
- Spirit wear and student swag
- Social media stickers & highlights
- Field day, pep rallies, yearbook

Where not to

- Website header or admissions materials
- Letterhead, tuition, or legal documents
- As a standalone signature for the school

05 — COLOR PALETTE

Our colors

Drawn directly from our existing marks: a rooted navy, a confident bay blue, and a soft steel accent — plus warm neutrals for text and background.

PRIMARY

Saint Navy
#1B2A4A

Bay Blue
#0C6CA8

Steel Blue
#7A9BC4

NEUTRALS

Parchment
#FAF9F6

Mist
#F5F6F8

Slate
#5B5F6A

Ink
#33363D

Usage: Navy for headlines and primary UI; Bay Blue for links, buttons, and active states; Steel Blue for accents and secondary highlights; Parchment as the primary background, never pure white.

06 — TYPOGRAPHY

Our type system

A clean, modern sans-serif system — confident enough for academics, warm enough for a school community. Two weights of one family family keep the system simple to maintain.

DISPLAY & HEADLINES

Libre Franklin

Weights used: 600 Semibold, 700 Bold, 800 Extrabold — headlines, nav, buttons, eyebrows

BODY & UI TEXT

Source Sans 3

Weights used: 400 Regular, 600 Semibold — paragraphs, form fields, captions

Aa
H1 · 800

Aa
H2 · 700

Aa
Nav · 600

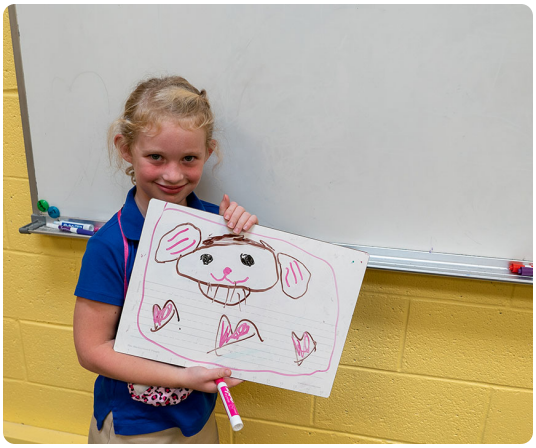
Aa
Body · 400

07 — PHOTOGRAPHY

Imagery style

Photography should feel candid and true to daily life at the school — natural light, real classrooms, genuine expressions. Avoid staged stock photography.











Do

- Warm, natural daylight
- Real students, staff, and families
- Genuine interaction and expression

Don't

- Generic stock photography
- Heavy filters or color grading
- Posed, stiff group shots

08 — WEBSITE UI

Applying it online

Informed by the rounded, pill-forward layout of the site template selected for the rebuild — reinterpreted in our own colors, type, and photography.

BUTTONS

Apply Now Schedule a Tour Learn more →

Pill-shaped, generously padded buttons to match the rounded, friendly system used on the new site build.

NAVIGATION

SAINT MARTIN'S LUTHERAN SCHOOL OF ANNAPOLIS

About Academics Admissions Give

CARDS



Early Childhood

Ages 3–5



Elementary

Grades K–5



Middle School

Grades 6–8

THANK YOU



Consistency builds trust — and trust brings families home to Saint Martin's.

Questions on applying this system to a new project? Keep this guide close and check back for updates as the brand grows.